

Monday, September 19

Another hurricane blew through the house this morning. Peter had to eat porridge again. He couldn't quite believe we were putting such pressure on him to finish. He was still crying and telling me to take my hands off him when Augusta came. When he calmed down he agreed to try for a better start tomorrow. Matthew took his turn. He held onto my pant leg and walked with me to the door. He cried when I handed him to Augusta.

Both Cheryl and I were tired today. My students behaved as though they had been penned in all weekend. I made it through the day and was sitting at my desk at 4 when Cheryl and the boys came in. Cheryl looked like I felt. She had been in doctors' offices since 1:45. Lappi had checked Peter's ear and found a pimple. Romanchuk says Peter's eye is improving and doesn't need another appointment for a year. He may be out of glasses when he's nine.

We asked Peter about kindergarten. He says, "We did the same thing today." We pursued further through play-acting. Peter was the teacher and we were the kids. He becomes very rigid and demanding. We are looking forwards to Parents' Night. We watched a PBS program on Orangutans. Peter giggled at the babies. Matthew fell twice off the sofa. He cuddled with Cheryl and stroked her chin as they watched.

Peter had another very good practise. Cheryl is pleased with his knowledge of pieces, tone, technique. Peter enjoys it more now.

I read Tuck to him. Matthew gets upset when he can't come into the room. I feel badly shutting him out but he tears at the book and Peter gets distracted. After, I went into the basement to do schoolwork, Social Studies and English prep.

Cheryl put Matthew down. She read a crafts magazine and bathed. I read some composition and watched the last few minutes of a Dolphins-Raiders game. We were in bed by 10:15. I could hear rasping sounds in Matthew's bedroom. Peter is able to sleep on both sides now that his ear doesn't hurt.